



Chalmers Beamer Template

A self-documenting tutorial deck

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2026-05-22

Outline



Quick start

Visual identity

Customisation



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What this template provides

Unofficial template

This is an *unofficial* community Beamer theme that approximates the 2026 Chalmers visual identity using the Chalmers logos and the official PowerPoint master as reference. It is not an official Chalmers product. For brand-critical materials consult the Chalmers Brand Portal.

- Primary brand colour: **Chalmers Purple** (#472DBE)
- Full accent palette (green, cyan, red, orange, yellow, pink, ...)
- Three slide types: cover, section divider, normal frame
- Four logo styles, three section-divider styles – pick once, applies everywhere
- Arial-like typography (Helvetica via the `helvet` package)



Minimal source

```
\documentclass[aspectratio=169]{beamer}
\usetheme{Chalmers}

\title{...}
\subtitle{...}
\shorttitle{Short title for footer}
\author{...}
\institute{...}
\date{2026-05-22}

\begin{document}
  \titleframe                % cover slide
  \begin{frame}{Outline}\tableofcontents\end{frame}
  \section{Introduction}     % auto-inserts a divider
  \begin{frame}{Topic}Hello, world.\end{frame}
\end{document}
```

File layout



File	Purpose
<code>beamerthemeChalmers.sty</code>	The theme (colours, fonts, layout)
<code>logographics/</code>	Chalmers logos (PNG)
<code>your-deck.tex</code>	This skeleton / tutorial deck
<code>README.md</code>	Full command reference

Drop the four items into any folder, edit `your-deck.tex`, run `pdflatex your-deck.tex` twice (the second pass renders the section dividers from the `.toc` file).



Three built-in slide types

- **Cover slide** – purple background, white logo top-right, title / subtitle / author / date.
Invoke with `\titleframe`.
- **Section divider** – purple background, list of all sections with the current one highlighted.
Inserted automatically by every `\section{...}`.
- **Normal content frame** – white background, purple title, logo top-right, footer with date | short title | slide number.

For custom layouts on a purple background (e.g. a closing splash, a hand-crafted divider) use the `chalmerscover` environment.



Custom purple frame – chalmerscover env

```
\begin{chalmerscover}
  \vfill
  \begin{center}
    {\color{white}\Huge\bfseries Thank you}\\[6mm]
    {\color{white}\Large Questions?}
  \end{center}
  \vfill
\end{chalmerscover}
```

Inside the environment you automatically get: purple background, white logo in the top-right corner (same position as every other slide), no footer. Drop in any content.



Frame alignment options

Beamer's standard [t], [c], [b] options work normally with this theme:

Option	Effect
--------	--------

[t]	content anchored to the top of the body area
-----	--

[c]	content vertically centred (Beamer default)
-----	---

[b]	content anchored to the bottom
-----	--------------------------------

This very slide uses [t] – the text sits just below the title.



Quick start

Visual identity

Customisation



Logo style switch

`\chalmersheadline{key}` selects which mark appears in the top-right corner of every slide:

Key	Logo
logo	avancez emblem only (default)
word	CHALMERS wordmark only
logo+word	avancez emblem + CHALMERS
logo+word+sub	emblem + CHALMERS + UNIVERSITY OF TECHNO- LOGY

The colour adapts automatically: purple on light slides, white on the cover and section dividers.



Colour palette – primary and neutrals

Name	Hex	Role
ChalmersPurple	#472DBE	primary; titles, bullets, rules
ChalmersPurpleDark	#332085	dark variant (pressed states)
ChalmersPurpleLight	#6746EB	lighter purple
ChalmersPurpleSoft	#9E92E8	soft purple (backgrounds)
ChalmersCream	#F0EDE6	warm off-white (block bodies)
ChalmersBlack	#222222	body text
ChalmersGrey	#7F7F7F	subtitles, muted text



Colour palette – accents (data viz)

Name	Hex	Suggested use
ChalmersGreen	#00B356	success, example block
ChalmersLime	#ADD739	accent
ChalmersCyan	#36B7F6	accent
ChalmersTeal	#61E9D2	accent
ChalmersRed	#D52515	alert block, warnings
ChalmersOrange	#ED7122	accent
ChalmersYellow	#F6D62A	highlight
ChalmersPink	#D987BA	accent

All names are defined as `xcolor` colours – use them anywhere: `\textcolor{ChalmersGreen}{...}`, `fill=ChalmersTeal`, etc.



Blocks

Standard block

Purple title, cream body. Use for key takeaways.

Alert block

Red title, faint red body. Use for warnings.

Example block

Green title, faint green body. Use for examples.

When to use which

- Plain block – summary, definition, "key idea"
- alertblock – caveat, exception, common mistake
- exampleblock – concrete instance, demo



Equations and units

Numbered equations work as usual:

$$\dot{\mathbf{x}} = f(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{u}), \tag{1}$$

where $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is the state vector and $\mathbf{u} \in \mathbb{R}^m$ is the control input.

Units use the `siunitx` package: $v_{\max} = 120 \text{ km/h}$, $g = 9.81 \text{ m/s}^2$.

Itemize bullets:

- Use Chalmers Purple as the bullet colour automatically.
- Sub-bullets use the lighter purple variant.



Tables (booktabs style)

Quantity	Symbol	Value
Vehicle mass	m	1500 kg
Wheelbase	L	3.0 m
Max speed	$v_{\max}$	35 m/s

Plain tabular + booktabs (no vertical lines, three horizontal rules). Caption goes *above* the table.



Three section-divider presets

Pick the look of slides inserted between sections via:

```
\chalmerssectiondividers{progress}    % DEFAULT  
\chalmerssectiondividers{solid}  
\chalmerssectiondividers{none}
```

Preset	What you see
progress	list of all sections, current big + bold + white, others smaller and dim ("you are here")
solid	purple full-bleed with just the section name
none	no divider slide at all



Fully custom dividers

For a one-off layout, redefine `\AtBeginSection` in your own `.tex` after `\usetheme{Chalmers}`. Inside, build the divider however you like; typically wrap content in `\begin{chalmerscover}...\end{chalmerscover}` to keep the purple-bg + white-logo style.



Quick start

Visual identity

Customisation



Overlays and notes in action

Staged bullets

- This bullet is on the first overlay



Overlays and notes in action

Staged bullets

- This bullet is on the first overlay
- This one appears on the second



Overlays and notes in action

Staged bullets

- This bullet is on the first overlay
- This one appears on the second
- And this on the third

Whole-block reveal

A `block` can carry an overlay specification too — this one appears with the third bullet.



Build modes – one source, several PDFs

Two independent axes. Overlays are a *class* option, so they are injected before `\documentclass`; the note states are `\setbeameroption` calls after `\usetheme`.

```
%\def\flatmode{} % or pass it on the command line
\ifdefined\flatmode
  \PassOptionsToClass{handout}{beamer}
\fi
\documentclass[aspectratio=169]{beamer}
```

```
pdflatex -jobname talk-flat "\def\flatmode{}\input{talk.tex}"
```

Switch	Overlays	Notes	Use
<i>(none)</i>	yes	hidden	projecting
<code>\flatmode</code>	no	hidden	reading, sharing
<code>\shownotes</code>	yes	after each slide	rehearsing
<code>\notesonly</code>	—	only notes	spoken script
<code>\presenterview</code>	yes	second screen	presenting



Build modes – two things to watch

handout **shows every overlay at once**

- `\only<N->` and `\pause` collapse cleanly
- `\includegraphics<2>` swaps and single-overlay `\only<2>` **stack** on top of each other

Do not combine `\flatmode` with a notes mode

- All of a frame's `\note<N>` blocks land on *one* note page
- Beamer note pages do not paginate, so the overflow is dropped — silently, with nothing in the log
- Keep rehearsal output on the overlay build



Override colours and fonts

Place any of these *after* `\usetheme{Chalmers}`:

```
% recolour the primary purple
\definecolor{ChalmersPurple}{HTML}{332085}
```

```
% recolour the frame title
\setbeamercolor{frametitle}{fg=ChalmersBlack}
```

```
% reduce the frame-title size
\setbeamerfont{frametitle}{family=\sffamily,series=\bfseries,size=\large}
```

The theme defines every visible element via `\setbeamercolor` / `\setbeamerfont` so any of them can be overridden in this way.



Override the footer

The default footer is *date* | *short title* | *slide number*. Override locally by redefining `footline`:

```
\setbeamertemplate{footline}{%  
  \usebeamercolor[fg]{footline}\usebeamerfont{footline}%  
  \vspace{1mm}%  
  \hbox to \paperwidth{\hfill\insertframenum\hspace{8mm}}}%  
  \vspace{1mm}%  
}
```

Available macros inside the template: `\insertdate`, `\insertshorttitle@chalmers`, `\insertframenum`, `\insertauthor`, `\insertinstitute`.



Adding a partner logo

For collaboration slides, drop the partner's PNG into `logographics/` and place it manually with TikZ:

```
\pgfdeclareimage[height=8mm]{partner}{logographics/your-partner-logo}  
% inside any frame body:  
\begin{tikzpicture}[remember picture,overlay]  
  \node[anchor=north east,xshift=-50mm,yshift=-5mm]  
    at (current page.north east) {\pgfuseimage{partner}};  
\end{tikzpicture}
```

Tune `xshift` so the partner logo doesn't collide with the Chalmers headline logo in the top-right.

Summary



- **Identity:** the 2026 Chalmers visual identity, primary colour Chalmers Purple (#472DBE).
- **Three slide types:** cover, section divider, normal – the logo sits at the *same* top-right position on all of them.
- **Pick once, applies everywhere:** a single `\chalmersheadline + \chalmerssectiondividers` setting in the preamble configures every slide.
- **Customisable:** every colour and font is a Beamer setting; override locally without touching the `.sty`.



Further reading

- `README.md` – full command reference, colour palette, customisation examples
- `beamerthemeChalmers.sty` – the theme itself, well commented section-by-section
- Chalmers Brand Portal – official brand guidelines and ceremonial-use rules for the *avancez* emblem



Thank you

Questions?

Bug reports and feature ideas welcome:

github.com/wenlzhang/chalmers-beamer